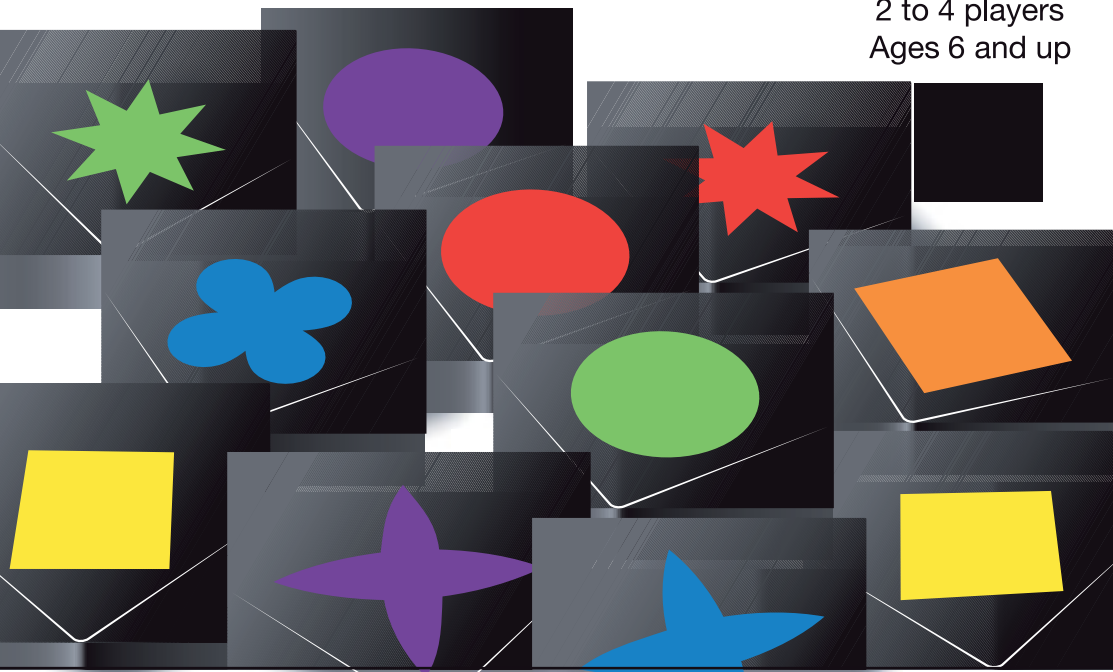


# Qwirkle™

Mix, Match, Score and Win!

2 to 4 players  
Ages 6 and up

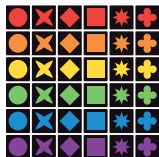




## How to Play

Number of players: 2-4    Playing time: 30 - 60 min.

Components:  
108 blocks,  
three of each  
of the thirty-six  
blocks shown  
at right.



## Object

Add blocks to the grid to score the most points.

## Setup

You need paper and pencil to keep score. Place all blocks face down. This is the draw pile. Each player draws six blocks and places them so that others cannot see the colored shapes. This is your hand.

## Starting the Game

Players declare the largest number of blocks they have that share one characteristic, either color or shape (do not include duplicate blocks in this). The player who has the most blocks that share one characteristic plays those blocks to start the game. If there is a tie, the oldest player in the tie starts the game. Play proceeds clockwise around the table.

## Play

On your turn, do one of three things:

1. Add one block to the grid, and then draw a block to bring your hand up to six.
2. Add two or more blocks to the grid. All blocks played from your hand must share one characteristic, either color or shape. Your blocks must be part of a single line, although they do not have to touch one another. Draw

blocks to bring your hand up to six.

3. Trade some or all of your blocks for different blocks from the draw pile.

## Adding to the Grid

Players take turns adding to the grid that is created on the first turn. All pieces must link to the grid.

There are six shapes and six colors. Players create lines of shapes and colors. Two or more blocks that touch each other create either a line of same shape or same color. Blocks that are added to a line must share the same characteristic as the blocks that are already in the line. Sometimes there are places on the grid where no block can be placed.

A line of shapes can only have one block of each of the six colors. For example, a line of squares can only have one blue square.

A line of color can only have one block of each of the six shapes. For example, a line of yellow can only have one yellow circle.

## Trading in Blocks

On your turn, you can choose to trade in some or all of your blocks **instead** of adding to the grid. Set aside the blocks you want to trade in, then draw replacement blocks. Finally, mix the blocks that you traded away back into the draw pile. If you are ever unable to add to the grid, you must trade in some or all of your blocks.

## Scoring

When you create a line, you score one point for each block in the line. Also, when you add to an existing line, you score one point for each block in that line, including blocks that were already in that line. One block can score two points if it is part of two different lines. See *Examples of Play*.

You score an additional six-point bonus whenever you complete a line of six blocks. The six blocks must be either six blocks of the same color, each a

different shape OR six blocks of the same shape, each a different color. A line of six blocks is called a Qwirkle. Lines of more than six blocks are not allowed. The player who ends the game gets a six-point bonus.

## Ending the Game

When there are no more blocks to draw, play continues as before, but players do not draw blocks at the end of their turn. The first player who uses all of their blocks ends the game and gets a six-point bonus. The player with the highest score wins.

## Strategy Tips

Count the blocks. For example, if you are waiting for a yellow circle, make sure there is at least one yellow circle that hasn't been played. Try to add to more than one line at a time. Try not to create rows or columns that are five blocks long as this creates an opportunity for an opponent to score lots of points.

## Examples of Play

**Sue** starts the game by playing three red blocks, each with a different shape. Sue scores 3 points.



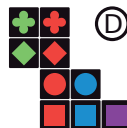
**Chris** plays three square blocks adding to the line of red created by Sue and also creating a line of squares. The red square scores two points for Chris because he played it in two lines at once. Chris scores 7 points.



**Sally** plays one blue circle. This creates two new lines: a circle line and a blue line. She scores 4 points.



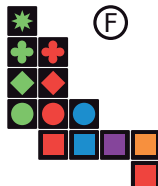
**Bob** plays two green blocks and creates three new lines: a diamond line, a clover line and a green line. Bob scores 6 points.



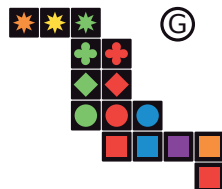
**Sue** plays two green blocks. Both blocks add to the same green line, but they are not touching each other. By adding to the existing green line and the existing circle line Sue scores 7 points.



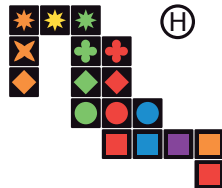
**Chris** plays two square blocks. He adds to the existing square line and also starts another square line. Chris could not have played both square blocks in the existing square line because then there would have been two red squares in that line. Chris scores 6 points.



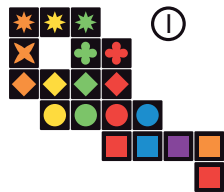
**Sally** plays two starburst blocks. She creates a starburst line. Ann scores three points.



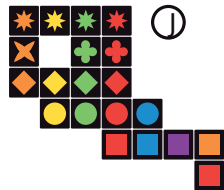
**Bob** plays two orange blocks. He creates an orange line. Bob has not added to the diamond line because his orange diamond doesn't touch the other two diamonds. Bob scores 3 points.



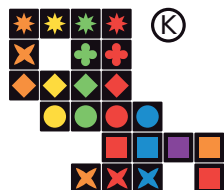
**Sue** plays two yellow blocks. She creates a yellow line and adds to both a diamond line and a circle line. Sue scores 10 points.



**Chris** plays one red starburst block. He adds to a starburst line and a red line. Chris scores 9 points.



**Sally** plays three criss-cross pieces. She creates a line of criss-cross pieces and adds to a red line and a blue line. She played the sixth red shape to create a Qwirkle and score a six-point bonus. Sally scores 18 points.



**Bob** plays two square pieces. He adds to one square line and starts two new square lines. Bob scores 9 points.

